



FOCUS ON... NITROGEN

Nitrogen is an important ingredient in the chemical industry. It is used in dyes, explosives, and fertilizers.



▲ Nitrogen compounds called azo dyes can be used to make many colours.

► Nitrogen-rich compounds are found in explosives such as dynamite. During an explosion, the nitrogen is released as a burst of pure gas.



▲ Farmers add fertilizers containing nitrogen to soil to help crops grow faster and taller.

Nitrogen

Earth's atmosphere is made up of about 78 per cent nitrogen, making this gas the most common pure element on Earth. While it is relatively rare in solid minerals, nitrogen is used by plants, fungi, and animals to make proteins.

ATOMIC MASS 14.007

STATE Gas

DISCOVERY 1772 (Daniel Rutherford)



Pure nitrogen in a glass sphere



This mineral is a mass of tiny crystals that are too small to see.